SUNY Old Westbury 2026-2027 Undergraduate Catalog

Course Descriptions

Contract All Courses |

Visual Arts

VA 2000 - Introduction to Art

Credits: 4

Studio course designed to introduce first-year students to exercises that challenge their assumptions of the creative process. This course will begin to provide students with the basic visual and verbal vocabulary to proceed to the next level in the Visual Arts curriculum. The exercises will be completed using both, the fundamentals of basic art techniques such as drawing, painting, modeling and fabricating, and references from contemporary art currents.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2010 - Introduction to Creative Thinking

Credits: 4

A must for students considering careers in advertising, publishing, communications or any other discipline regarding creative visual solutions. Students solve exercises designed to challenge the way we perceive reality through conditioning and stereotypes. A variety of skills are developed at the beginners level. The objective is to develop in the students the skills to make creative visual statements avoiding conventional thinking. Required for Art majors.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2020 - Basic Design

Credits: 4

This studio course deals with the fundamental development of visual structures and the relationship among two, three, and four (time) dimensions. Through structured projects, beginning with point and visual rhythm, the course will explore line, plane, and color. Students will learn the fundamental principals to organizing these multi-dimensions as they relate to graphics, interior design, photography, etc. and how to make informed intelligent visual decisions. The relationship between the traditional crafts such as painting, sculpture and the new electronic media arts will be discussed and studied. Required for all art majors.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2030 - Drawing

Credits: 4

The process of art from idea to final product. The emphasis is on visual notations, especially drawings. Deals with planning and studying feasibilities before actually entering production, allowing students to work through an idea. Required for all art majors.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2045 - Introduction to Color

Credits: 4

This class is for those who were always afraid of color and mystified on how color combinations work. The course will be a studio class using paint and paper working through a series of projects exploring: color theory and terminology, how it is applied to practical situations; the difference between subtractive systems as seen in the chemical world of paint and the additive system as demonstrated in electronic media and the calibration of computer monitors and color systems such as RGB, CYMK, etc. How harmonic-complementary and discordant uses of color are used in nature; after images and optical mixes of color; camouflage and how it works in nature and design; color in relation to 3-dimentional form and more will be addressed. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

Prerequisites

ECI

VA 2320 - Graphic Design I

Credits: 4

This course introduces the elements and principles of graphic design as building blocks that lead to effective visual communication. A series of projects focus on developing problem solving skills as well as knowledge of the software involved in creating successful design projects. Several influential design movements are covered in relation to specific principles of design. Emphasis is placed on taking initial ideas through to fully realized projects that communicate effectively. Areas covered include typography, page layout, book design, packaging and logo design, poster design and design for the web. Projects will be created in Adobe software: InDesign, Photoshop, Illustrator and Dreamweaver.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2400 - Introduction to Photography

Credits: 4

Beginning course for art-majors and non-art majors in photography. Emphasis is on photography as a system of visual and cultural representation. The history of photography and technical data are interspersed with shooting assignments and critique. Students supply their own materials and should own a medium-quality digital camera.

Prerequisites

EC I

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2460 - Painting I

Credits: 4

This is a beginning course, which teaches the student the conventions of pictorial space and the language of color, as well as basic painting techniques. The study of syntax of traditional painting and the mastery of materials and techniques are basic components of the class. Class assignments and individual projects explore technical, conceptual, and historical issues central to understanding the language of painting. Paintings from different historical periods are discussed in relation to contemporary painting today.

Prerequisites

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When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2500 - Art History I: 19th Century Art

Credits: 4

This class begins with the history of Modern Art in 1750 in the context of the Enlightenment and the French Revolution. It covers the major movements in European Art including Neo Classicism, Romanticism, Realism, Impressionism, and Post-Impressionism. Artistic developments are presented within their historical and social contexts. We will study the changing role of art in by considering the impact that dramatic political upheavals and the Industrial Revolution had on the idea and production of art.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Once every year. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2510 - Art History II: Modern Art: 1900- 1945

Credits: 4

This second part of the survey begins with the art of the twentieth century. It examines the many challenges to the definition and role of art that emerge from the major movements of the century such as Cubism, Surrealism, Dada, and Abstract Expressionism. The course traces the impact of photography, mass production, and politics on the role of art in early 20th century society. It also examines the split that occurs between artists who wish to make politically engaged art and artists who wish to make art for art's sake.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Once every year. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2520 - History of Photography

Credits: 4

This course introduces the history of photography from its inception in the 1830's to recent practices of photographers and artists working with digital technologies. The primary goals of the course are to develop visual literacy, acquire familiarity with complex and contradictory genres, and understand the social functions of photographic image production. This course will look at significant examples of photography in art, science, war, and other fields and discuss the concepts that relate to this work.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2600 - Study Abroad in France

Credits: 4

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Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

In the summer. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 2750 - Sculpture I

Credits: 4

Sculpture I is an introduction to the concepts, materials, and methods of sculpture. The class will explore a wide variety of sculptural tools and techniques, both traditional and digital. The class will include an introduction to digital fabrication, basic mold making, and CNC milling. Along with form making and composition, the properties and potential of various materials will also be investigated. Emphasis is placed on the relationship of material to concept, and the processes used in making a sculpture. In addition, the course will address contemporary issues relating to sculpture in the late twentieth and early twenty-first centuries.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 3100 - Visual Culture: Warhol to the Present

Credits: 4

This course examines the role of art in a contemporary society inundated with visual imagery. We will situate the major art movements of the 1960s and 70s (Pop, Minimalism, Conceptual Art, Performance and Post Modernism) within the socio- historical context of the Civil Rights Movement, the Vietnam War and the development of contemporary technologies. The course considers how contemporary art comments upon such diverse issues of race, gender and sexuality. We will also look at how the critic, the gallery, and the museum help to determine how art is defined. Required for all Art majors.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Once a year. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 3200 - Art Tutorials I

Credits: 4

Art majors must meet in tutorial sessions with the instructor to discuss ongoing work in any media. Criticism is geared to development of self confidence in the creative process and to implement technical and productive solutions. All students are required to meet with collective faculty for criticism. Required for all Art majors. (Teacher Education majors who have selected the Visual Arts concentration will learn to analyze the creative process as it relates to the classroom; how to conceptualize, and plan projects that explore creativity.)

Prerequisites

VA 2010

and two foundation courses; ECI

When Offered:

Every semester.

VA 3320 - Graphic Design I

Credits: 4

This course introduces the elements and principles of graphic design as building blocks that lead to effective visual communication. A series of projects focus on developing problem solving skills as well as knowledge of the software involved in creating successful design projects. Several influential design movements are covered in relation to specific principles of design. Emphasis is placed on taking initial ideas through to fully realized projects that communicate effectively. Areas covered include typography, page layout, book design, packaging and logo design, poster design and design for the web. Projects will be created in Adobe software: InDesign, Photoshop, Illustrator and Dreamweaver.

Prerequisites

ECI**Corequisite** none**Prerequisite/Corequisite**

none

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.**Note:**

VA 3320 Graphic Design I is the same course content as VA 2320 Graphic Design I and will replace that course due to level change

.VA 3340 - Introduction to African Arts

Credits: 4

An introduction to the traditional and contemporary arts of the African continent. We will explore the relationship of the visual arts and the complex historical, cultural and religious context of traditional African societies. Parts of the course will be devoted to contemporary arts in post-colonial Africa, transnational developments, the internationalization of African arts and aspects of Diaspora arts.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Once a year. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

.VA 3350 - Topics in Contemporary Art: New Media

Credits: 4

This course examines recent trends and developments in the field of new media. It discusses the relation of contemporary art to other cultural, political and technological developments.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Once a year. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 3360 - Topics in Contemporary Art: Art Since 1980

Credits: 4

This course examines recent trends and developments in contemporary art since 1980 and discusses it in relation to the cultural and socio-political context. Topics include: identity, body politics, socially engaged art.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Once a year. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 3380 - Digital Video

Credits: 4

Students will obtain a strong foundation in digital video on the Macintosh computer through instruction in preproduction and production fundamentals. Video editing will be done with Adobe Premiere software. Students will have their own computer workstations and access to cameras, recorders, color scanners and printers. This course will provide students with the knowledge of the aesthetic, critical and analytical processes required to create effective digital videos.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester.

VA 3400 - Digital Imaging

Credits: 4

This course covers the capabilities of both pixel-based and vector-based digital imaging software. Using Photoshop, students create a range of projects that explore the creative potential within these programs while developing the skills necessary to execute original concepts. This course serves as a digital foundation upon which more advanced digital work in both 2D and 3D design can be built. It is a must for anyone considering a career in communications, publishing,

advertising and the visual arts.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 3456 - Creative Coding: Art & Games

Credits: 4

Creative Coding: Art and Games focuses on the development of a contemporary art practice incorporating interactivity and technological developments from the ground up for the creation of Art and Art-based games. What types of artworks can be conceptualized and produced when incorporating computing power? Students will learn the basics for working within the realm of physical computing; computer interfaces that go beyond the typical keyboard and mouse. The course will begin instruction with small-scale programmable computers called microcontrollers and students will become familiar with building electronic circuits in service of creative output. This course will also explore generative visual output through the fundamental steps and concepts of programming including variables, conditionals, iteration, and functions. Particular attention will be focused on creation of interactivity, whether this includes controlling and programming digital games or physical and digital artwork. This course will utilize weekly exercises to build dedicated technical skills, discussions and readings to foster critical understandings of the interactive media possibilities, and midterm and final projects to explore personal interests with conceptual rigor and creative freedom.

Prerequisites

Intro to Creative Thinking , ECI

VA 3460 - Painting I

Credits: 4

This is a beginning course, which teaches the student the conventions of pictorial space and the language of color, as well as basic painting techniques. The study of syntax of traditional painting and the mastery of materials and techniques are basic components of the class. Class assignments and individual projects explore technical, conceptual, and historical issues central to understanding the language of painting. Paintings from different historical periods are

discussed in relation to contemporary painting today.

Prerequisites

ECI**Corequisite** none**Prerequisite/Corequisite**

none

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.**Note:**

VA 3460 Painting I is the same course content as VA 2460 Painting I and will replace that course due to level change

VA 3750 - Sculpture I

Credits: 4

Sculpture I is an introduction to the concepts, materials, and methods of sculpture. The class will explore a wide variety of sculptural tools and techniques, both traditional and digital. The class will include an introduction to digital fabrication, basic mold making, and CNC milling. Along with form making and composition, the properties and potential of various materials will also be investigated. Emphasis is placed on the relationship of material to concept, and the processes used in making a sculpture. In addition, the course will address contemporary issues relating to sculpture in the late twentieth and early twenty-first centuries.

Prerequisites

ECI**Corequisite** none**Prerequisite/Corequisite**

none

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.**Note:**

VA 3750 Sculpture I is the same course content as VA 2750 Sculpture I and will replace that course due to level change

VA 3800 - Performance Art

Credits: 4

This course is an active introduction to performance art where students can expect to engage in physical, time based art making. The course provides students with a thorough exploration of performance art that includes process, research, and critique as they plan and engage in their own works of performance art. Students will learn about many formats of

performance art such as outdoor, one-on-one, performance for video, location specific, collaborative performance, and reenactment. Students can expect to work with cameras and equipment necessary for the creation of their own performance art ideas. The course will also include ideas of self-care and how to prepare oneself to make art.

VA 4200 - Art Tutorials II

Credits: 4

This course is the second level of the Tutorial Sequence. Required for all Art majors. (Teacher Education majors who have selected the Visual Arts concentration will focus on how to teach the creative process.) This is the second level of the tutorials sequence that focuses on the processing of students' own projects. Materials, techniques, and theory of criticism will be covered.

Prerequisites

All foundation courses; VA 3200

; ECI

When Offered:

Every semester.

VA 4260 - Interactive Web Design

Credits: 4

This course emphasizes design elements and principles as well as technical methods for creating interactive projects for the web. Working on their own original projects, students will gain a comprehensive understanding of hypertext mark-up language, cascading style sheets, interface design, and graphics protocol. Basic javascript to create interactivity, eBooks, and a game design wherein students create their own artwork, is also covered. Students use Dreamweaver, Photoshop, Javascript, text editors, Flash, ePub, and a game design content management system to create projects.

Prerequisites

EC1

When Offered:

Every semester.

VA 4265 - 3D Digital Design

Credits: 4

This course will cover 3D modeling and an introduction to 3D animation. Polygon and Surface modeling, as well as sculpting and rigging, will be taught as tools for expressing students' own ideas for creating 3D environment, character and object designs. From these projects, students will be introduced to the methods of animating and 3D printing of their models.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester.

VA 4320 - Graphic Design II

Credits: 4

This course builds upon the elements and principles of graphic design outlined in Graphic Design I. Students will develop concepts that lead to effective design solutions across media platforms including: print design, packaging and logo design, web, eBook and environmental design. Students will use a variety of Adobe software: InDesign, Photoshop, Illustrator, Dreamweaver, Flash and ePub.

Prerequisites

Graphic Design I or permission of the instructor

When Offered:

Every semester.

VA 4360 - Advanced 3D Design and Animation

Credits: 4

This course is designed for students to further develop projects at an advanced level in the Electronic Media areas of animation, 3D design, and 3D printing and animation. Previous experience in the area of 3D design is required.

Prerequisites

VA 4265

When Offered:

Every semester.

.VA 4460 - Digital Animation

Credits: 4

This course teaches the principles of storyboarding, digital imaging, stop-motion animation, cel animation, key frame animation and sound. Utilizing Adobe software, students will conceptualize, design, draw and compose digital animations.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester.

.VA 4466 - Painting II

Credits: 4

This course emphasizes the command of the conventions of pictorial space and the use of color through the medium of paint. Futher study of the syntax of traditional painting and the mastery of materials and techniques are basic components of the class. Advanced assignments and individual projects explore conceptual and historical issues central to understanding the language of painting.

Prerequisites

Painting I, or with Instructor's permission**Corequisite** none**Prerequisite/Corequisite**

none

Note:

VA 4460 Painting II is the same content as VA 3460 Painting II and replaces the existing course due to level change

VA 4750 - Sculpture II

Credits: 4

Sculpture II builds upon the concepts and tools learned in Sculpture I with a more rigorous conceptual approach and an elevated development of materials and skills. The second semester of sculpture continues to develop the student's conceptual, visual and technical skills acquired in Sculpture I with increased levels of complexity and an emphasis on developing digital sculpture, interactivity and 2D fabrication. This course provides students with a solid understanding of the basis of digital fabrication as it applies to 3-D printing, CNC milling, small scale electronics and component-based assembly methods. Students will evolve their abilities to explore the interdependence of content and medium in a critical and contemporary art context.

Prerequisites

ECI

When Offered:

Every semester. Satisfies Liberal Education Curriculum requirement.

VA 4900 - Internship

Credits: 4

Students intent on becoming professional artists will use this Internship to work with an established artist. Students interested in peripheral art activities will use this Internship in a professional area close to his/her interest.

Prerequisites

All foundation courses; ECI

When Offered:

Every semester. Required of all Art majors; 120 hrs. minimum.

VA 5200 - Art Tutorials III

Credits: 4

This course is the third level of the Tutorial Sequence. Required of all Art majors. (Teacher Education majors who have selected the Visual Arts concentration will focus on research skills, delving into the value of the creative process in art, as

it applies to problem solving, and the relationship of the creative process in art as it relates to other fields and disciplines.)

Prerequisites

All foundation courses; VA 3200

; VA 4200

; ECI

When Offered:

Every semester.

.VA 5900 - Senior Project

Credits: 4

Upon recommendation of the VA faculty and with the student holding a minimum GPA of 3.0 in Art Tutorials II and Art Tutorials III, the Student will create art work for an exhibition at the campus' Amelie A. Wallace Gallery. Other Art Majors who have finished the Art Tutorial sequence, but are not recommended for a final exhibition, will instead write a final Senior Thesis. This thesis will address an art topic to be decided on, in consultation with the Visual Arts Faculty. Teacher Education majors who have selected the Visual Arts concentration will use Senior Project as an opportunity to assemble a final portfolio of sample art projects, a written journal of classroom observations and techniques and a research paper on the possibilities of integrating the art process into the classroom as a learning tool. Seniors passing Senior Project - Art Exhibition will receive recommendations for MFA programs. Students who choose to graduate with a thesis will be recommended into MA programs.

Prerequisites

VA 3200

, VA 4200

and VA 5200

, approval by faculty after VA 5200

; ECI , Senior Standing

When Offered:

Every semester.

VA 9990 - Independent Study

Credits: 4

Students work on independent art projects. or independent art history research.

Prerequisites

All foundation courses; VA 3200

; ECI and permission of Instructor

When Offered:

Every semester.

Contract All Courses |